Deliverable 3: Final Game Prototype and Showcase Presentation (40%)

Submission Deadline: April 05, 11:30 PM on Brightspace

- **Submission Format:** One submission per team, clearly labeled (e.g., GroupName_Deliverable3.zip).
- **Team-Based Submission:** Each team must submit a single deliverable that represents their completed game and showcase presentation.

Deliverable 3: Final Game Prototype and Showcase Presentation (40%) marks the culmination of your work throughout the course. By this stage, you have already laid a strong foundation through Deliverable 1 and Deliverable 2, focusing on conceptual frameworks (fun, flow, engagement; MDA; player types), core and meta gameplay loops, paper prototyping, level design, narrative, systems balance, and progression mechanics. Now, you will refine your project further by integrating **art, aesthetics, and sound design**, performing **extensive playtesting and iteration**, and bringing your final game to a polished state ready for a broader audience.

Your final submission begins with a **completed, fully functional Unity prototype** that demonstrates cohesive implementation of all design elements introduced earlier. You should illustrate how your level design has matured, showing nuanced pacing, intuitive player guidance, and a suitable balance between challenge and exploration. The narrative design should feel immersive and coherent, with well-integrated lore, dialogue, and world-building that enhance the overall gameplay experience. Resource and progression systems must be well-balanced, supporting players' motivations through carefully calibrated risk-reward mechanics, leveling schemes, or unlockable content.

An essential evolution at this stage is your **art, aesthetics, and sound design**. Even if you are using placeholders or partial assets, your submission should show a clear aesthetic direction—demonstrating thoughtful choices in user interface (UI) layouts, visual style, and music or sound effects to heighten engagement. This refinement includes ensuring consistent visual feedback for player actions, cohesive color schemes for environments and characters, and audio cues that reinforce gameplay moments (such as success, danger, or discovery).

Your submission must also include evidence of **robust playtesting and iteration**, summarizing how you gathered feedback from class peers, testers, or your own observations, and how this feedback led you to adjust mechanics, rework level design, or refine progression balances. If any parts of the game proved particularly challenging—such as a boss encounter or a puzzle sequence—describe the design changes you made to achieve fairness, maintain tension, or foster a sense of accomplishment. Additionally, highlight any debugging or performance optimizations you performed to improve stability and responsiveness.

To showcase your final prototype, record a **short video presentation** that provides an overview of your game's premise, its core systems, and its most compelling gameplay moments. This video should be submitted to the course Dropbox in lieu of a live, in-class presentation. The recording should concisely illustrate how players interact with your game, the visual and auditory atmosphere you have crafted, and the overall user experience you aim to deliver. Ensure the video offers a clear walkthrough or demonstration of key features, allowing viewers to appreciate the progression from your early concepts to the polished state you have now achieved.

Finally, compile all necessary **Unity project files** (again including only the Assets, Packages, and ProjectSettings directories) along with a **functional Windows build**, ensuring that instructors and peers can access and play your game without additional software. Organize your submission into a single .zip file, clearly labeled with your group or individual name. Double-check that your final build runs smoothly and that you have removed any extraneous files to avoid bloated archives. Submit both the .zip file and your **showcase video** to the designated Dropbox link by the stated deadline.

With this final deliverable, you bring together every element of game design explored in the course, reflecting on how the theoretical concepts of fun, flow, engagement, player motivations, and iterative refinement have shaped your final product. Your completed prototype and recorded demonstration should embody a cohesive, polished experience—one that merges thoughtful design, functional mechanics, artistic flair, and a deep awareness of player feedback into a game you can confidently share and evaluate.

What to Submit in Deliverable 3

In this final submission, you will bring together every aspect of your game design and development progress:

1. **Game Prototype (Unity Project & Executable):**
   Provide a **fully functional Unity project** containing only the necessary folders—Assets, Packages, and ProjectSettings—so that your instructors can open and review the game if needed.
   Alongside the project files, include a **Windows build** (an .exe and accompanying Data folder) that allows reviewers to play your final game without requiring the Unity Editor. Make sure the build runs smoothly, with no missing assets or critical bugs.
2. **PDF Documentation:**
   Submit a brief but comprehensive report (5–10 pages) explaining the final state of your game. Summarize the evolution of your design from initial concepts to final polish, referencing the core principles covered throughout the course:
   - Art, Aesthetics, & Sound Design: Describe your choices in visuals, UI, and audio.
   - Narrative & Systems Integration: Show how lore, story elements, and mechanics work together.
   - Progression & Balance: Highlight your leveling or rewards systems and how you've balanced them.
   - Playtesting & Iteration: Demonstrate how feedback influenced final refinements.

- Technical Implementation: Provide an overview of notable Unity features, scripts, or design patterns.

3. **Showcase Presentation (Recorded Video):**
   Instead of an in-person demo, you must submit a **short video** (3–5 minutes) that presents your final prototype. This recording should succinctly show:
   - The game's core premise and setting.
   - A guided walkthrough of key gameplay features (movement, combat, puzzle-solving, etc.).
   - Visual or audio highlights (animations, sound effects, user interface).
   - Any unique selling points or polished moments that differentiate your game.

Package all items (project folder, Windows build, PDF report, and video file or link) into a **single .zip archive** labeled appropriately (e.g., GroupName_Deliverable3.zip) and upload it to the course Dropbox by the specified due date. Double-check that your files are accessible, that the game build is fully operational, and that your video can be viewed without issue.

Rubric for Deliverable 3: Final Game Prototype and Showcase Presentation (40%)

Criterion	Description	Points
Unity Implementation & Polish	Evaluates the stability and completeness of the final build. Looks for well-structured Unity project files, minimal bugs, and a smooth gameplay experience. Considers technical complexity and finishing touches (e.g., performance optimizations).	0-20
Art, Aesthetics & Sound Design	Assesses visual coherence (color schemes, character/environment design), interface clarity, and effective use of music or sound effects. Focuses on how well these elements enhance immersion and overall player experience.	0-20
Narrative & Systems Integration	Reviews the cohesion between story/lore and gameplay mechanics. Expects balanced resource or progression systems that align with the narrative context. Considers how effectively all subsystems (e.g., AI, puzzles) work together.	0-20
Playtesting & Iteration	Examines the extent to which feedback has been incorporated. Looks for improvements since previous deliverables, evidence of user testing, and documentation of iterative design changes that enhance player engagement and clarity.	0-20
Presentation & Documentation	Considers the clarity, organization, and completeness of the PDF report. Evaluates the recorded showcase video's effectiveness in demonstrating core gameplay elements, visual style, and overall appeal. Reflects on professionalism and coherence.	0-20

Total Points Available: 100 (40% of overall course grade)